DO YOU KNOW?

Two year old babies can understand 100 to 150 words and start to add about 10 new words per day

- By the third month the baby coos and babbles before he/she speaks words. These two along with gestures are known as pre -speech forms.
- By six months he/she produces most of the vowels and few consonants sounds.

Cooing – quick burst of squealing noise.

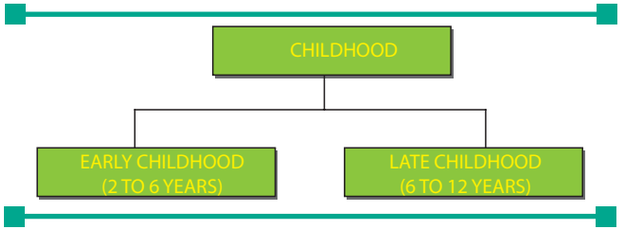
Babbling – production of inarticulate meaningless speech sounds which are sequences of vowels and consonants such as da-da-da.

g. Physiological Function

Babyhood is the time when the fundamental physiological patterns of eating, sleeping and elimination should be established, even though the habit formation may not be completed when babyhood ends.

2.2.3 Childhood

Childhood begins at the conclusion of babyhood and extends to the time when the child becomes sexually mature at thirteen years for girls and fourteen for boys. Childhood period is now divided into – early and late childhood.



2.2.3.1 Early Childhood

1. Pattern of Development in Early Childhood

Growth during early childhood proceeds at a slow rate when compared with the rapid rate of growth in babyhood.

a. Physical Development in Early Childhood

i. Height

The average annual increase in height is 2.5 inches. By the age of six, the average child measures 46.6 inches (118.36 centimeters).



ii. Body weight

The average annual increase in weight is around 1.6-2.3 kilograms. At age six, children should weigh approximately 7 times as much as they did at birth. An average girl weighs 25-30 kilograms and boy weighs 30-32 kilograms.

iii. Body proportions

Body proportions change markedly and the baby look disappears. Facial features look small but chin becomes more pronounced and neck elongates. The stockiness of the trunk is decreased and the abdomen appears flat. Chest and shoulder become broader and flatter. Muscle begins to form and growth of the head slows down. Arms and legs lengthen and hands and feet grow bigger.

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